Appendix C. Cedar authorization with OpenClaw agents

This appendix provides hands-on demonstrations of the authorization patterns introduced in chapter 18. These examples show how Cedar policies can shape agent behavior during execution, planning, and delegation.

The demonstrations use OpenClaw, an open-source framework for tool-using language model agents, together with a lightweight Cedar policy decision point (PDP). The goal is not to build a production system, but to make the architectural ideas from chapter 18 concrete and observable.

You will run three demonstrations:

- **Reactive authorization**—the agent attempts actions and adapts to permit or deny decisions
- **Constraint-aware planning**—the agent queries policy constraints before acting
- **Delegation as data**—a main agent grants a subagent a restricted subset of its authority

Together, these examples show how authorization becomes part of the agent's runtime behavior.

The demonstrations correspond directly to the patterns described in chapter 18:

- Section 18.3—policy-aware agent loop
- Section 18.4—policy constraints guiding planning
- Section 18.6—delegation and subagents

Each demo builds on the previous one. You should run them in order.